

Status: Posted

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SR TECH SUPPORT ENG EEE | Reports to: Tushar Vaja

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Impact is **what** you accomplish - and **how** you do it matters just as much.

WHAT

What results have you delivered for your goals, keeping security, quality, and AI in mind?



HOW

How have your behaviors and actions led you, your team and Microsoft to excel, grow, and build trust?

Reflect on the past

What results did you deliver, and how did you do it?

Compliance & Security

- I collaborated in the bug bash sessions for **ASC + TSE**, part of *Microsoft's Secure Future Initiative* (SFI). The project introduced a single support identity in ASC (tool widely used by Support Engineers), improving isolation and reducing security risks. I tested real-world scenarios and submitted results on time to program managers, helping ensure a smooth transition for CSS engineers.
- All mandatory security trainings completed.

Empower customers to realize business value

- To deliver a differentiated support experience, I used AI tools extensively to improve and create dozens of **self-help** articles for Serverless (updating content, refining Alchemy rules, and adding training data to boost Alchemy ML model confidence). Tools like Zebra AI and Copilot were essential to this process; without them, it wouldn't have been possible to review and produce such a large volume of content in a short period.
- As a result, **Alchemy Solution Coverage** for Serverless, increased from **11.67%** in July to **37%** in September, helping more customers find solutions on their own and supporting our goal of reducing case volume through stronger self-help experiences.

Deliver differentiated customer experiences & operational excellence

- I've been helping the Delivery team accelerate case resolution and reduce backlog for Synapse Serverless and Fabric Warehouse, leading *backlog triages* across APAC/EMEA to unblock long-running cases and improve visibility. In this process, I've prepared RCAs, resolved ICMs, connected with different product teams for complex investigations, and joined recovery calls for escalated cases. In every interaction, I focus on collaboration, inclusion, and a supportive team culture. In interactions with customers I consistently exhibited the CARE Behaviors, showing empathy, accountability, and a customer-first mindset.
- Between July and October, backlog health for *Serverless + Synapse Link* improved considerably, showing clear progress in reducing older cases and keeping the flow of new cases under control.
- **Key backlog improvements (Jul → Oct):**
 - Total backlog: 94 → 79 (–16%)
 - 16 – 30 days: 27 → 13 (–51%)
 - 31+ days: 31 → 25 (–19%)
 - These results reflect consistent backlog reviews, closer collaboration with Delivery and Product Group, and a strong focus on accelerating case closure and preventing long-running issues.
- For Serverless, we saw solid progress in **Days to Close (DTC)**, improving from **24 days** in August to **16.7** in October. During the same period, 395 cases were created and 417 closed, indicating a positive trend toward backlog reduction and stronger operational health.
- These actions directly contributed to an average **CSAT of 4.89** out of 5 this FY, reflecting our focus on faster resolutions, collaboration, and quality customer experiences.

Lead AI Transformation at scale

- I've been leveraging AI tools to make support processes smarter and more efficient. Through **DfM Copilot Hub**, I've used targeted prompts to **accelerate case reviews**, capture customer sentiment, and quickly identify blockers, reducing review time and improving focus on actions that drive progress.
- Using **Python & Azure Foundry AI**, I partnered with Yamandeep to analyze backlog, uncovering insights on backlog distribution, regional trends, and case ownership patterns. These insights help EEs work smarter and prioritize high-impact actions.
- I also used **Zebra AI** and **Copilot 365** to identify case patterns and gaps in self-help content, create and enhance articles, and improve **Alchemy ML training data**. As mentioned earlier, these efforts led to a clear and significant increase in *Solution Coverage* during the first trimester.
- To help Support Engineers resolve cases faster through concise and effective troubleshooting guides (and also to improve **DfM Agent Copilot** responses), I collaborated in the **OnePager** initiative, **reviewing 283 PRs** (151 for Serverless and 132 for Azure Data Explorer).

Reflect on recent setbacks - what did you learn and how did you grow?

Last month I completed my first year with the Supportability team and a strong period of learning, supported by great collaboration with my peers.

Collaboration

Looking back, I realize I could have achieved even more by collaborating earlier with others. For example, when we identified a high concentration of long-running Serverless cases in Asia, I initially tried to handle many of them alone. Later, by engaging SMEs, I see how teamwork can accelerate and improve impact. Moving forward, I plan to strengthen these partnerships to deliver faster results.

AI Learning and growth

At first, I struggled to choose the right AI tools among so many options. After joining training sessions and learning from peers, I learned how to use each one more strategically to improve productivity and outcomes. I completed the AI-900 certification last year and am now studying *Develop AI Solutions in Azure (AI-102)* and RAG to deepen my technical understanding and apply AI more effectively in my daily work.

Manager comments

Silas, Thank you for your contribution in security compliance, customer enablement, and AI-driven transformation. Your work on the ASC + TSE bug bash for SFI ensured a smooth transition to a single support identity, reducing security risks and improving isolation. Completing all mandatory security training reflects your commitment to compliance and trust. On customer enablement, you drove significant improvements inAlchemy coverage for Serverless, increasing from 11.67% to 37%, which helped customers self-solve and reduced case volume. Your efforts in backlog triage across APAC/EMEA, RCA preparation, and escalation handling improved operational health—backlog reduced by 16% overall, aged cases (>30 days) dropped by 51%, and DTC improved from 24 days to 16.7 days. These actions contributed to a strong CSAT of 4.89, demonstrating customer obsession and quality delivery.

Leveraging Copilot, Zebra AI, and Python/Azure Foundry to accelerate case reviews, analyze backlog trends, and enhance self-help content. Reviewing 283 OnePager PRs for Serverless and ADX further strengthened troubleshooting resources and Copilot responses. These efforts reflect innovation and a growth mindset.

I appreciate your openness in learning from setbacks—recognizing the need for earlier collaboration and improving AI tool usage shows adaptability. Completing AI-900 and pursuing AI-102 and RAG training positions you well for deeper technical impact.

Looking ahead, play to your strength in customer handling and ensure better scoping and expectation setting to avoid prolonged cases. Close the loop on insights from case/ICM reviews by translating them into Product improvement or semester asks and ADO items, and present these in MBR/MSR for engineering traction. Continue to own your components end-to-end, lead with example as a senior team member, and pair problem statements with actionable solutions. Your collaboration on ADX and RTI workloads has been commendable—thank you for supporting peers and driving team success.

Completing your first full year in Supportability gives you a strong foundation; now is the time to lead initiatives and expand your impact in FY26.

Plan for the future

What are your goals for the upcoming period?

Auto Assigned

Goal #1. Build trust through product excellence

Build foundational trust through reliable, resilient, and secure solutions and champion customer feedback to continuously improve the products we deliver.

1. 1 SECURITY FIRST CULTURE: Ensure customer security and privacy is prioritized through strict adherence to the latest security-enhanced processes and tools (CSS Secure Future Initiative).
2. 2 IDENTIFY TOOLING AND SERVICE IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES: Provide feedback from across the support ecosystem (be the voice of the customer, delivery partners, peers...) identify deficiencies and apply ways to improve our service through leveraging appropriate feedback channels with the intent to maximize value for support engineer efficiency and our customers.

Auto Assigned

Goal #2. Differentiate through world class Customer Experience

Relentlessly pursue a simple, consistent, and connected customer experience that delights customers and grows our business.

1. 1 DELIVER A DIFFERENTIATED SUPPORT EXPERIENCE: Deliver a simple, consistent, and connected support experience by taking full ownership of customer cases and ensuring positive outcomes. Prioritize core case-handling excellence, excellent backlog management and ensure every customer interaction is resolved with care and quality. Foster a customer-first culture by prioritizing the customer and their issues above all else, minimizing transfers and escalations through focus on case ownership, and accelerating resolution through accountability and smart execution.
2. 2 BUILD CUSTOMER / PARTNER LOYALTY: Exhibit the CARE Behaviors in every interaction. Practicing customer empathy and striving to become the reason customers and partners choose Microsoft. Help build CSS's reputation as an organization that puts Customers and Partners first through exhibiting customer obsession, case and issue ownership, and technical excellence.

Auto Assigned

Goal #3. Drive operational excellence through AI

As Customer Zero, leverage AI to accelerate our digital transformation and model the productivity and efficiency gains through our products, platforms, and solutions.

1. 1 TECHNICAL AI LEADERSHIP: Embrace the 'customer zero' mission by utilizing and promoting the latest technology and ensuring accurate, up to date, and comprehensive case notes for AI consumption. Provide constructive feedback and provide new ideas where we might apply AI to drive additional efficiencies and enhance tooling and adoption through appropriate feedback channels and engaging with your local & global communities.

Auto Assigned

Goal #4. Unleash our talent to unlock customer value

Bring deep customer and domain understanding—product, technical, business, and industry—enabling us to drive customer value

1. 1 PERSONALIZED DEVELOPMENT PLAN: Own and prioritize your development plan (technical and soft-skills); have discussions with your manager to reach agreement on both the priorities and necessary time commitment in the plan. Prioritize building deep technical skills in your domain of expertise.
2. 2 TRUSTED ADVISOR: Acquire the necessary AI skills & experience to enhance your knowledge. Utilize the full breadth/depth of your expertise (including AI) to build customer trust and deliver successful outcomes.

Auto Assigned

Goal #5. Accelerate customer outcomes through delivery excellence

Obsess over driving value for our customers through shaping the right offers and delivering support proactively and reactively, directly and alongside partners.

1. 1 DELIVER A CONSISTENT, HIGH QUALITY CUSTOMER SUPPORT EXPERIENCE: Exhibit extreme ownership for every case in your backlog, through reducing transfers, timely responses to customers, driving technical resolution, proactively escalating and getting the help you need if a case is not progressing. Following through on customer commitments, exhibiting operational rigor by following case management standards and processes consistently (including new AI technologies). Keep case notes up to date and ensure warm handoffs when a handoff is absolutely required.
2. 2 OWN THE INCIDENT, LEAD THE MITIGATION: Act as the Incident Commander for every high-severity case you own. Take full ownership of the technical mitigation, demonstrating decisive leadership and sound judgment in escalating to management, technical escalation, or field engagement teams when needed. Be a strong partner when collaborating across other CSS teams to drive resolution and seamless communication. Ensure clear, proactive communication with the customer, maintain momentum through well-defined next steps, and document all troubleshooting and case progress thoroughly.

Auto Assigned

Goal #6. Compliance

Personally, commit to generate and protect Microsoft trust by living Microsoft's values, culture, and Trust Code in every decision.

All Roles:

- Integrity & ethical behaviors modeled every day. Full adherence to Company policies and processes. 100% of mandatory Compliance Trainings completed timely.
- Cooperation and help on remediation actions with audits, investigations and other compliance processes & controls. Proactive identification of risks inherent to the role and timely escalation of concerns.

All Leaders & Managers (Additional CIS):

- Healthy team culture in which employees feel recognized for making ethical choices and share concerns. Consistent advocacy for the importance of advancing a culture of compliance. Team's adherence to policies & processes and timely completion of mandatory compliance trainings. Active support for controls, review processes and investigations through effective remediation of control failures. Connects are leveraged to document impact and improvement areas.

How will your actions and behaviors help you reach your goals?

- With focus on helping the Delivery team deliver the best support experience to Fabric customers, I will collaborate on the review and improvement of the **Fabric RTI Eventhouse L200** content. This work aims to strengthen technical readiness and ensure consistent, high-quality guidance for support engineers. The target completion date is **December 15, 2025**.
- I plan to complete the **AI-102 course** by the **end of January, 2026** and achieve certification approval by early February, supporting Microsoft's broader AI Readiness strategy and vision for an AI-powered future. While this goal aligns with the *AI/Vantage* initiative, it's also part of my own commitment to deepen my AI expertise and apply it to Supportability real-world scenarios. I'll keep looking for opportunities to use AI to increase my impact and amplify Supportability initiatives.

Manager comments

Your planned actions align well with our priorities and demonstrate a proactive approach to both technical readiness and AI enablement. Collaborating on the review and improvement of Fabric RTI Eventhouse L200 content will strengthen guidance for support engineers and ensure consistent, high-quality customer experiences. Completing the AI-102 certification and applying those learnings to real-world Supportability scenarios reflects a growth mindset and supports Microsoft's AI-first vision.

I encourage you to continue looking for opportunities to leverage AI for automation and efficiency, and to share insights broadly so the team benefits from your expertise. Completing your first full year in Supportability gives you a strong foundation; now is the time to lead initiatives and expand your impact in FY26.

Our OKRs remain unchanged since the start of the fiscal year. Key focus areas for the remainder of FY26 are:

1. Volume Reduction - Goal: SHS 55%, Coverage 80

- Self-Help Solutions: Empower customers to self-solve via Alchemy, Apollo, error messages, public docs.
- Product Improvements: Submit high-quality, high-impact asks based on case/ICM reviews; track deployed impact.
- Engagement: Drive Monthly Business Reviews with engineering for traction on top priorities.

2. Support Efficiency - Goal: DTC ↓10%, SR→ICM <10%

- CRI Management:
 - Full rollout of Escalation Layer; zero CRIs without owner or misroutes.
 - Reduce backlog; no CRIs open for closed cases.
 - 100% CRI quality/classification; close high-risk/long-running CRIs.
- Proactive Backlog Management:
 - Reduce cases >30 days; increase closures within 7 days.
 - Daily triage and delivery team partnership.

3. Knowledge Management & Engineer Readiness

- CCM / IAPP:
 - Leverage CCM for low-complex cases via Copilot/AI tools.
 - Ensure L100–L300 content availability, strong IA and F1 score.
 - Align content roadmap with CCM and MyHorizon.
- Agent Copilot (DFM):
 - Usage >80% of cases; improve HRR; reduce thumbs-down.
 - Review negative feedback within 2 weeks; grow prompt library.
- Content Management:
 - No stale content; readiness for new features
 - High-quality TSGs, concise wikis, one-pagers for faster resolution.
 - Strong governance: routing, tagging, compliance, relevance.
 - Leverage AI for content creation and make AI ready content for consumption by various tools like copilots, automations, etc.

4. AI Learning & Enablement

- Adopt AI-first mindset; automate repetitive tasks.

- Complete AI-900 certification by Q3 (aspirational Q2).
- Upskill in GenAI; apply learnings to efficiency and case optimization.
- Complete Fabric onboarding; expand scope; mentor new team members.

5. Security

- Complete all mandatory security/privacy training on time.
- Handle customer data securely e.g. no PII in TSGs.
- Ensure AI solutions comply with SFI guidelines.